

Fractional AI Mandate Charter

A practical contract for aligning executive ambition, decision rights, portfolio choices, governance, workflow adoption, and permanent ownership.

Use the charter to shape the brief before the organization scales the work. It is a discovery mechanism, not a maturity score.

CLAUSE	CHARTER PROMPT	MINIMUM EVIDENCE	NAMED AUTHORITY
1 • Outcome	What operating, customer, risk, employee, or market consequence must change?	Baseline, unit, beneficiary, value hypothesis, time horizon	Executive sponsor and accountable business owner
2 • Authority	Who can fund, sequence, stop, release, override, and accept residual risk?	Decision record, retained human judgment, escalation path	Board/committee, sponsor, risk and workflow owners
3 • Portfolio	Which work will be built, bought, partnered, delayed, scaled, held, or stopped?	Value, feasibility, data, reuse, capacity, cost, dependency	Portfolio forum with finance and technical representation
4 • Guardrails	What must be true before AI is used, released, expanded, or allowed to act?	Access, sources, evaluation, privacy, security, fallback, monitoring	Technical, data, risk, legal, security, and release authority
5 • Adoption	What changes in work, role, judgment, handoff, support, and behavior?	Workflow owner, training, usage, repetition, feedback, performance	Business/workflow owner and enablement owner
6 • Continuity	What permanent leadership and operating system should exist at handoff?	Cadence, records, talent, owner readiness, unresolved decisions	Permanent executive owner or approved search mandate

CHARTER DECISION

Initiate

Outcome, sponsor, owner, controls, and evidence are strong enough to mobilize.

Repair first

The opportunity is credible, but authority, data, governance, or operating capacity must be fixed before funding the work.

Do not pursue

The work lacks strategic value, accountable ownership, feasible evidence, or an acceptable risk posture.

FOUR REVIEW MOMENTS

MOMENT	PRIMARY QUESTION	CHARTER MOVEMENT	DECISION
Discovery	Is the stated AI ambition the actual operating mandate?	Draft all six clauses; identify missing facts and owners.	Proceed with discovery, repair sponsorship, or stop.
Portfolio funding	Which small set of work earns capacity and executive sponsorship?	Lock Outcome, Authority, Portfolio, and Guardrails.	Fund, sequence, buy, partner, delay, or reject.
Proof review	Is the operating system producing value, control, and adoption evidence?	Update Guardrails, Adoption, and economic evidence.	Scale, redesign, hold, or stop.
Handoff review	Can permanent leaders govern and improve the system independently?	Lock Continuity and unresolved-decision record.	Transfer, hire, extend for a bounded mandate, or close.

MANDATORY ATTACHMENTS

Decision-rights map

Who recommends, decides, executes, reviews, overrides, accepts risk, and communicates.

Portfolio register

Outcome, owner, workflow, technical posture, dependencies, evidence, economics, and next decision.

Governance and exception record

Policy, access, data and source controls, evaluation, fallback, human authority, exceptions, and closure.

Adoption and handoff scorecard

Repeated use, workflow change, support burden, trust, owner readiness, talent, cadence, and open risk.

ILLUSTRATIVE CONTEXT SHIFTS

CLIENT CONTEXT	LIKELY FIRST EMPHASIS	TYPICAL HIDDEN BURDEN
Financial services	Governance, portfolio selection, data/model controls, board confidence	Shadow AI, fragmented authority, evidence burden, vendor exposure
Professional services	Repeatable delivery leverage, knowledge controls, practitioner adoption	Client confidentiality, craft erosion, local experimentation, weak reuse
Industrial operations	Workflow reliability, machine/quality signals, human override, standard work	Disconnected telemetry, exception handling, safety/quality authority
AI-enabled growth	Differentiating capability, platform choices, cost/evaluation, talent sequence	Vendor lock-in, release discipline, unclear product/technology ownership

All scenarios are illustrative discovery contexts. They are not claims about confidential Axial Search clients. The charter is independent candidate work by Russell Dudek.